

GROSS NATIONAL HAPPINESS IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN GROSS NATIONAL PRODUCT.

KING JIGME SINGYE WANGCHUCK OF BHUTAN

Paying out

GDP can tell us about countries' incomes, but to see how well a country is faring economically, we must also look at how much money is going out. Countries, like people, may borrow money for specific projects and have debts to repay. And most countries rely on some international trade, so it's important to note whether there's more money coming into the country than going out—this is described as a surplus—or more going out—this is a deficit.



MEASURING HAPPINESS

It's often said that money can't buy you happiness. In 1972 the King of Bhutan stated that his country may be poor, but his people are happy, and argued there should be a measure of Gross National Happiness as well as GDP. Economists have

taken the idea seriously and there is now an annual World Happiness Report, published by the United Nations.